

COLORADO FIELD ORNITHOLOGISTS - SIGHT RECORD FORM

NEW STATE RECORD ☐UNUSUAL RECORD ☒

Please print or type. Attach photographs and additional pages if necessary.

Species: RED-THROATED LOON GAVIA STELLATA
(Vernacular Name) (Scientific Name)Date(s): NOVEMBER 8 1986Number of birds seen: ONE Sex: UNKNOWN Plumage: WINTERLocality: CHERRY CREEK RECREATION AREA Elevation: 5000'Nearest town: AURORA County: ARAPAHOETime(s) observed: SEVERAL TIMES BETWEEN 9:30 and 11:30 AMDuration of observation (e.g. 1 sec., 5 min., etc.): ONE HOUR

Other observers who saw the bird with you (give names, addresses, telephone numbers):

DAVID BLUE 3145 WESTLIFE DRIVE WEST, COLORADO SPRINGS, CO 80906WILLIAM MAYNARD 372 BLUE WINDSOR LANE, COLORADO SPRINGS, CO 80906

Other observers who saw the bird independently (give names, addresses, telephone numbers)

PAN BRIDGES, ROBERT RICHTER AND JACK REDDALL

Light conditions (position of bird to light and shade, direction and strength of light):

BRIGHT SUNNY DAY, BIRD SEEN IN DIRECT SUNLIGHT.Optical equipment used (e.g. power, types): TELESCOPE 20-45 XDistance, and how measured: 1/4 MILE ESTIMATED

If photographed, type of equipment and film: _____

Who else photographed the bird? _____

Describe the bird's behavior (e.g. flying, feeding, or habits used in identifying):

BIRD WAS SEEN SWIMMING AND DIVING IN RESERVOIR ALONG WITH OTHER LOONS - ONEPACIFIC LOON AND FOUR COMMON LOONS ON RESERVOIR. (3 SPECIES IN SCOPE AT SAME TIME)

Describe in detail the bird's relative size, overall shape, plumage and color pattern. Include details of bill, wing and tail shape. Give particular emphasis to marks you used to identify the bird. Reference to its resemblance to field guide descriptions and illustrations is not enough. Describe only what you actually observe in the field:

THE BIRD WAS DISTINCTLY SMALLER THAN THE PACIFIC LOON AND MUCH SMALLER THAN THE COMMON LOON IN OVERALL LENGTH AND SIZE. THE NECK APPEARED THINNER AND THE BILL SMALLER THAN THE PACIFIC LOON AND BOTH MUCH SMALLER THAN IN THE COMMON LOON.

Description (continued):

WHEN SWIMMING THE BILL AND HEAD WAS HELD UP-TURNED LIKE, BUT NOT AT QUITE SUCH A LARGE ANGLE AS A CORMORANT (ALSO PRESENT ON RESERVOIR). THE LOWER MANDIBLE APPEARED UP-TURNED, BUT THIS IS DIFFICULT TO SEE AT THIS DISTANCE. THE HEAD WAS GRAY, NOTICEABLY LIGHTER THAN THE BACK, AND THE CHANGE TO THE WHITE ON THE FRONT OF THE BIRD ^{WAS GRADUAL.} THE BIRD STILL HAD A SMALL DARK PATCH ON THE UPPER THROAT. THE PACIFIC LOON HAD A DARK BROWN-BLACK HEAD, THE SAME COLOR AS THE BACK AND A DISTINCT LINE TO THE WHITE ON THE FRONT. THE BIRD DID NOT APPEAR TO BE HEAVILY SPECKLED ON THE BACK, AS OTHERS I HAVE SEEN. Describe the bird's song and call, if given, including method of delivery, (i.e. from perch, in flight, duration):

Describe the general and specific habitat in which you observed the bird:

PLAINS RESERVOIR.

How did you eliminate similarly appearing species?

PACIFIC LOON - OVERALL SIZE, BILL & NECK SIZE, UP-TURNED HEAD & BILL, HEAD & NECK COLOR CONTRAST TO BACK COLOR AND DIFFUSE TRANSITION TO WHITE ON FRONT.

COMMON & YELLOW-BILLED LOONS - SEVERAL OF ABOVE CHARACTERS ONLY MORE SO ON SIZE.

WHITE-BELLIED CORMORANT - OVERALL SHAPE, SIZE AND COLOR. What is your prior experience with this and similarly appearing species?

I AM FAMILIAR WITH COMMON, PACIFIC & RED-THROATED LOONS ON BOTH COASTS AND SOME IN COLORADO. VERY FAMILIAR WITH P-C CORMORANT. I HAVE SEEN YELLOW-BILLED LOON TWICE.

List books, illustrations, recordings, other birders, etc. consulted and how this influenced your identification:

a) at time of observation: NATIONAL GEOGRAPHIC FIELD GUIDE.

b) after observation:

This report was written from reports made during _____, after observation ☒ from memory _____
Date and time report was written: 8th NOVEMBER 1986

Reporting observer: PETER R. GENT Signature: Peter R. Gent

Address: 55 SOUTH 35th ST, BOULDER, CO 80303

All reports will be maintained permanently at the address below:

Return to:

CURATOR, DEPARTMENT OF ZOOLOGICAL COLLECTIONS
DENVER MUSEUM OF NATURAL HISTORY
CITY PARK
DENVER, CO 80205